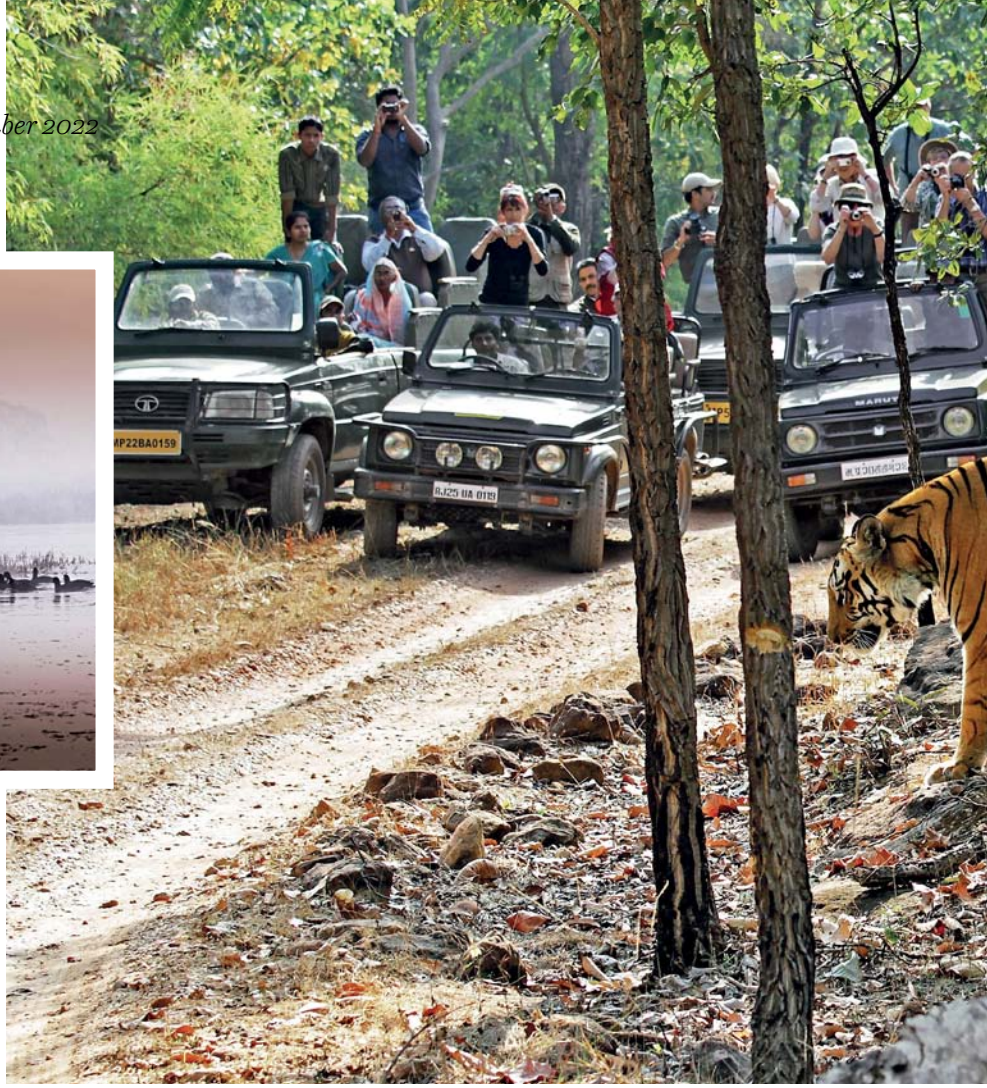
ALAMY





Keoladeo Ghana, Rajasthan, is home to a rich fauna, including 380 avian species

Keoladeo Ghana National Park, Rajasthan

Just a couple hundred kilometres from Delhi is a birding bastion that has attracted passionate twitchers from over the world. Keoladeo Ghana, notified as a national park in 1982 and inscribed as Unesco World Heritage Site three years later, is home to close to 380 resident and migratory avian species, including its illustrious resident sarus crane, which can grow up to six feet high (until the 1990s, Siberian cranes were regular visitors here), painted storks, nightjars, and grey-billed tufted ducks. It is commonly accepted that birdwatching demands patience on an unconditional basis sometimes, but that's hardly true here, with even rickshaw pullers operating within the park precincts proving to be decent guides.

WATCH OUT FOR
Large groups of painted storks perched upon trees, entirely indifferent to or fearful of human presence

VISIT
Sept. onwards, especially if you're a sucker for birds of prey

CALL OF THE WILD

They span just a percent and a half of India's landmass, but national parks are home to its most invaluable ecosystems. In winters, when winged visitors arrive from across the globe, the theatre of the natural world plays out like nowhere else. Here are the 10 best places to witness it

By PRANAY CHANDER



SHUTTERSTOCK